

Sesquiterpene Lactones



What is it?

Sesquiterpenes are essential oils. They are in the *Compositae* (a.k.a. Asteraceae) family of plants. The allergens are in the leaf, stem, flower, and possibly the pollen of the plant.

Allergic contact dermatitis can occur from direct contact with the plants. It can also occur from pollen (direct or airborne). Finally, it may occur from products that use the extracts.

SESQUITERPENE LACTONES can also be known as:

- Terpenes
- Elecampane camphor
- *Compositae*

Some Possible Uses of SESQUITERPENE LACTONES / Where it might be found:

Extracts of these plants may be in medicated creams, perfumes, cosmetics, teas, supplements, and foods.

Here is a list of plants in this family:

- Chrysanthemum
- Chamomile
- Feverfew
- Echinacea
- Cornflower
- Daisy and sunflower
- Marigold
- Mountain tobacco (a.k.a Arnica)
- Dandelion
- Ragweed
- Artichoke
- Lettuce
- Endive
- Bay leaf

- Tulip tree (a.k.a Liriodendron)
- Liverwort (a.k.a Frullania)
- Ornamentals
 - Stokesia
 - Vernonia
- Wild Growing Compositae Plants:
 - Feverfew, wild feverfew
 - Pyrethrum
 - Elecampane
 - March elder
 - Costus root
 - Sneezewood
 - Ordinary milfoil/yarrow
 - Tansy
 - Mugwort
 - Ragweed
 - German and field chamomile
 - Dandelion
 - Cornflower
 - Daisy
- Compositae Plants found in Herbaceous Borders/Gardens:
 - Chrysanthemum
 - Dahlia
 - Sunflower
 - Mangold
- Edible/Medicinal Compositae Plants:
 - Endive
 - Lettuce
 - Chicory
 - Artichoke
 - Bayleaf
 - Chamomile
 - Sunflower
 - Echinacea
 - Magnolia (Magnoliaceae)
 - Liverwort (Jubulaceae)

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What should I do to avoid SESQUITERPENE LACTONES?

Avoid these plants and their extracts. It is important to look at the complete ingredient list on the label of each product you use. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's or store's website.

To find a possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list or plant family of each product you encounter.

It can be very difficult to avoid contact with all species of this family. Try to remove those that are in your house, yard, and garden. Use gloves for gardening and handling listed vegetables. Applying Ivy Block may give some protection. Avoid prolonged outdoor activity when these plants are in bloom. Close windows against their pollen. Avoid contact with the bark of chopped firewood, as it may have liverwort on it. Airborne contact dermatitis may mimic a sun induced rash.

Sometimes eating these plants or taking herbal supplements or teas made from them may worsen a rash.

If you use the CAMP app, your provider will designate whether you need to avoid Sesquiterpene lactones and fragrance or just Sesquiterpene lactones.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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